



*Once Cronos had defeated his father,
Ouranos, he became king of the gods. He took
his Titan sister Rhea to be his wife
and queen.*

First, to honor his promise to his mother, Gaia, he sent his brother Oceanus to release their gigantic siblings, the Hecatoncheires and the Cyclopes, from inside Gaia, where Ouranos had sent them. When they were brought to him, however, Cronos was threatened by their power and immediately sent them back. This infuriated Gaia, who cursed him: “Cronos, one day your own child will overthrow you, just as you overthrew your father.”

*Cronos was afraid of his mother’s curse, so he decided to
get rid of his children when they were babies.*

Rhea and Cronos had six children. First, Rhea gave birth to three daughters—Hestia, Demeter, and Hera—and then two sons—Hades and Poseidon. One by one, as soon as they were born, Cronos took them from his wife and swallowed them whole. As immortal beings, they could not be killed, but all five children were trapped inside their father’s stomach, unable to escape. Cronos was pleased with himself. “There’s no way that Gaia’s curse can come true now,” he thought.